OMENAI

GLOBAL CULTURE CONTENT TAXONOMY

Editorial strategy, AI newsroom rules & storytelling standards

Stories Shaping Culture.

A working playbook for the Omenai team and AI intelligence layer.

VERSION 1.0 • OCTOBER 2026

1. Executive Direction

This document defines what Omenai covers, where the AI newsroom should look, how it judges story potential, and how the team turns discoveries into distinctive editorial products.

Omenai is a global contemporary culture media company. Omenai Insider explores the people, places, ideas, objects and creative movements shaping how we see and experience the world. Africa is the foundation of Omenai's relationships and editorial knowledge—not a boundary around its ambition.

Brand line: Stories Shaping Culture.

Editorial promise: Go beyond announcements and surface-level trends to explain why a person, place, object, creative movement or cultural shift matters.

Strategic principle: Global in perspective. Selective in coverage. Distinctive in taste.

What we are not: A general news aggregator, art-market listings service, luxury shopping feed or publication that reports every cultural announcement simply because it is new.

The AI layer is editorial infrastructure. It should improve discovery, research, organization and reuse—not define Omenai's public identity or replace human editorial judgment.

How to use this document

- Developers: implement taxonomy, source registry, metadata, scoring, deduplication and review workflow.
- Editorial team: use the pillars and standards to judge fit, choose angles and assign stories to channels.
- AI agents: treat these rules as constraints. Recommend; do not automatically publish.
- Leadership: review geographic weighting, content mix and thresholds after 30–60 days of real use.

2. Omenai’s Voice & Differentiation

The system should learn Omenai’s editorial judgment—not merely imitate a writing style.

Omenai’s value is the selection and interpretation of culture: knowing what is worth attention, finding the story beneath the headline, and presenting it with intelligence, curiosity and visual sensitivity.

Voice attributes

- **Culturally intelligent:** connect creative work or events to context, history, people, institutions and wider significance.
- **Curious and considered:** ask better questions; avoid hot takes and unsupported certainty.
- **Visually aware:** notice spaces, materials, objects, gestures, environments and details that can carry a story.
- **Globally minded, context-specific:** understand local histories; never treat cultures as interchangeable.
- **Premium without pretension:** sophisticated, clear and inviting—not status-obsessed or inaccessible.
- **Independent-minded:** do not simply repeat press releases, brand language or consensus coverage.
- **Human and precise:** favor concrete detail and specific observations over abstract jargon.

Avoid

- Generic phrases such as “breaking barriers,” “redefining the landscape,” or “at the intersection of” unless genuinely warranted.
- Breathless hype, clickbait, empty superlatives and luxury language without substance.
- Shallow trend reporting, celebrity gossip, viral content with no meaningful cultural angle, or routine event listings presented as major stories.
- Treating Africa as monolithic, exotic, newly discovered or relevant only when validated by Western institutions.
- Reducing Global South stories to struggle, politics or adversity; cover innovation, pleasure, ambition, humor, everyday life and complexity too.
- Invented quotes, inferred motivations presented as facts, fake access, synthetic imagery represented as documentary evidence.

Editorial test

Before recommending a story, the agent must complete: “This matters to Omenai’s audience because…” If it cannot give a specific, evidence-based answer, it should not recommend the story.

3. Geographic Strategy & Priority

Geography guides discovery; editorial significance determines selection.

Africa first; Brazil and the wider Global South next; then the UK, Europe, the United States and other global cultural centers. This reflects Omenai's origin, relationships and opportunity—not a rule that a stronger story must lose to a weaker one elsewhere.

Priority	Geographic scope	What to look for
Tier 1 — Africa	West, East, North, Central and Southern Africa. Potential hubs: Lagos, Accra, Dakar, Abidjan, Nairobi, Addis Ababa, Johannesburg, Cape Town, Marrakech, Cairo, Kinshasa and others.	Artists and creative communities; collectors and institutions; architecture, fashion, film, music, design, cultural spaces, local histories and contemporary change. Do not treat the continent as one market.
Tier 2 — Brazil & Global South	Brazil explicitly; Latin America and the Caribbean; South Asia; Southeast Asia; parts of the Middle East; other relevant Global South contexts.	Distinctive creative movements, cultural institutions, design, film, architecture, music, collecting, heritage and cross-border exchange. Seek local sources and context.
Tier 3 — UK & Europe	United Kingdom and European cultural centers, including London, Paris, Milan, Berlin, Lisbon, Basel and others.	Institutions and fairs, fashion and design, architecture, influential people, collections, cultural spaces and stories with wider significance.
Tier 4 — North America	New York, Los Angeles, Chicago, Miami and other relevant US and Canadian cities.	Creative industries, collectors, institutions, cinema, design, architecture, fashion, music and meaningful cross-regional stories.
Tier 5 — Wider global opportunities	East Asia, Oceania and any other location, including Tokyo, Seoul, Hong Kong, Dubai and others.	Exceptional stories with cultural consequence, originality, visual potential or international relevance. Geography alone is not a reason to include or exclude.

Geographic operating rules

- Use tiers to weight discovery, not impose rigid publishing quotas.
- Africa is the foundational strength; Brazil and the wider Global South are deliberate expansion priorities, not token coverage.
- A story from any region can outrank a higher-priority region if it is substantially more significant, original or compelling.
- Tag story location and cultural connections; allow multiple places, diasporas and transnational networks.
- Build source registries by region and language where feasible; English-language visibility is not a proxy for cultural importance.
- Review geographic diversity over 30/90 days. Imbalance prompts editorial review, not weak stories.

4. Core Editorial Taxonomy

Assign every candidate one primary pillar and any relevant secondary tags. Pillars describe Omenai’s editorial territory; they do not automatically make every story suitable.

A. Art & Creative Expression

- Contemporary art, artists and creative practices
- Painting, sculpture, photography, installation and public art
- Art collecting, collectors, patrons and private collections
- Galleries, museums, foundations, biennials, fairs and exhibitions
- Artist studios, workshops, residencies and creative spaces
- Art history, archives, rediscovered artists and overlooked movements
- Craft, ceramics, textiles and material culture in contemporary context
- Digital art, new media and creative technology
- Art markets, patronage, philanthropy, provenance and restitution

B. Fashion, Design & Objects

- Fashion houses, designers, independent labels and creative directors
- Fashion history, archives, craft and production
- Jewelry, watches, accessories and collectible objects
- Furniture, collectible design, product and industrial design
- Architecture, interiors, graphic design and typography
- Craftsmanship, ateliers, materials and manufacturing
- Design weeks, fashion shows and major creative platforms
- Iconic objects and design classics with cultural histories
- Material innovation and sustainability when there is a concrete story

C. Film, Music & Performance

- Cinema, independent film, documentaries and filmmakers
- Film festivals, premieres and international cinema
- Music, musicians, producers, albums, genres and scenes
- Music videos, visual albums and sound as cultural expression
- Theater, dance, performance art and live culture
- Television, streaming, animation and experimental media
- Creative work behind entertainment and its cultural impact
- Celebrity coverage only when it reveals a meaningful cultural or creative story

D. Places, Architecture & Ways of Living

- Architecture, landmark buildings and urban transformation
- Private homes, studios, collections and personal environments
- Hotels, hospitality and culturally significant destinations
- Restaurants, food culture, influential chefs and culinary heritage

- Cities, neighborhoods, public spaces, landscapes and gardens
- Travel through art, design, architecture, history and local culture
- Domestic rituals, entertaining and how people inhabit spaces
- Creative districts, cultural infrastructure and places reshaping a city
- Real estate only when architecture, design, history or cultural life is central

E. People, Influence & Cultural Institutions

- Artists, designers, architects, filmmakers, musicians and writers
- Collectors, patrons, curators, gallerists and cultural conveners
- Founders, creative entrepreneurs and institution builders
- Creative directors, publishers, tastemakers and cultural thinkers
- Profiles, interviews, oral histories and career retrospectives
- Creative families, legacies and dynasties
- People behind museums, foundations, studios, festivals and cultural spaces
- Personal collections, working environments and the ideas behind a person’s practice

F. Ideas, History & Cultural Change

- Cultural history, heritage, memory and preservation
- Intellectual movements, creative philosophies and schools of thought
- Identity, belonging, diaspora and cultural exchange
- Colonial histories and documented influence on contemporary culture
- Restitution, ownership, provenance and stewardship of cultural objects
- Globalization, cross-cultural influence and changing creative networks
- Technology and AI’s concrete effects on creativity and cultural work
- Changing ideas of luxury, taste, status and aspiration
- Subcultures, countercultures and youth movements
- Creative-industry economics, patronage and institutional power
- Cultural debates where stakes and evidence can be explained

Cross-cutting tags

Luxury & Connoisseurship; Emerging Talent; Cultural Institutions; Cultural Commerce; Heritage & Rediscovery; Global Cultural Exchange; Contemporary Debates; Cultural Milestones; Craft & Materiality; Collections & Patronage; Creative Technology.

5. What the AI Should Not Recommend

These exclusions prevent the newsroom from becoming a generic culture-news aggregator.

- Routine announcements with no broader significance: standard openings, appointments, product drops or event listings without a distinctive angle.
- Press releases repackaged as editorial. A press release can be a lead, never the full story by itself.
- Celebrity gossip, personal drama, unverified rumors or social-media virality without a meaningful cultural question.
- Generic luxury lifestyle content that is primarily promotional or built around status consumption.
- Stories selected only because a famous person, brand or institution is involved.
- Repeated coverage of the same event or announcement without new information or a genuinely different angle.
- Thin listicles, SEO filler and trend pieces with no credible evidence.
- Controversy included only for engagement; cover it when it materially shapes culture and can be reported responsibly.
- Stories whose key claims cannot be verified, sources are unclear, or image/footage use has no legitimate path.
- Geographic tokenism: weak stories included only to make the feed look balanced.
- Sponsor relevance alone. Commercial fit is secondary, never a substitute for editorial merit.

Exception policy: a normally excluded subject may be recommended when a specific, evidence-based cultural angle meets Omenai’s standards. The agent must explain the exception.

6. Story Formats & Channel Routing

Subject and publishing format are separate fields. One discovery can support multiple formats, but each needs its own angle and purpose.

Format / destination	Use it for	Initial guidance
Omenai Insider — Weekly Briefing	Curated cultural developments, discoveries, selected art/exhibition news and useful recommendations.	One edition every Thursday. Maintain cadence; seek a coherent editorial thread without forcing every item into one topic.
Omenai Insider — editorials	Original features, profiles, interviews, cultural histories, essays and explainers.	Start with 1–2 strong pieces per week. Human publisher controls free/paid access.
Omenai Originals — flagship film	In-depth people, collections, spaces, creative practices and cinematic cultural narratives.	One active flagship production at a time during pilot phase.
Short-form video / social	Visual cultural histories, story-behind-the-object, concise profiles, place-led narratives and explainers.	Target 2–3 finished videos weekly initially; prioritize strong visual potential.
Guides & curated selections	Exhibitions, destinations, cultural itineraries, people to know and discoveries worth saving.	Publish when useful and well researched; avoid generic listings without curation.
Rapid-response alert	Major time-sensitive cultural developments relevant to Omenai.	High threshold; keep separate from routine discovery.

Repurposing rule

Do not copy the same content into multiple channels. Identify the strongest angle for each: a feature adds context; a short film reveals a person or place visually; a briefing item explains what happened and why it matters.

Free versus paid is not a discovery category. The AI recommends editorial merit and channel fit. A human publisher controls paywall, email distribution and subscription strategy.

7. AI Newsroom Cadence & Recommendation Volume

Deliver a manageable, high-quality shortlist—not a firehose.

Cadence	AI output	Purpose
Daily discovery	Aim for 5–8 qualified new recommendations per day; fewer if quality is low.	Scan sources, verify freshness, cluster duplicates and explain why each item matters.
Weekly editorial review	8–12 shortlisted opportunities across the coming week and rolling pipeline.	Human team selects stories, balances formats/geography, assigns owners and defines angles.
Rapid response	Event-driven, high-threshold alerts only.	Escalate exceptional developments that cannot wait for weekly review.
Monthly review	Performance and pipeline report.	Review decisions, source quality, geographic/pillar balance, bottlenecks and audience signals.

Initial publishing capacity (not a quota)

- One Weekly Briefing each Thursday.
- One to two standalone editorial pieces per week.
- Two to three finished short-form videos per week.
- One flagship film in development at a time until workflow and economics are proven.

Do not pad output to hit a number. Three exceptional candidates are better than eight weak ones. Discovery volume is a ceiling and planning aid, not a minimum quota.

Weekly review questions

- Which stories are genuinely new, consequential or under-covered?
- Which have a strong Omenai-specific angle beyond the headline?
- What mix of geography, pillar and format best serves the publication?
- Which opportunities have access, source or visual assets that make original storytelling possible?
- What should be dropped, deferred, merged or investigated further?
- What do performance signals suggest, without letting clicks alone dictate editorial choices?

8. Story Scoring & Decision Rules

Use scoring to prioritize human attention, not to pretend editorial judgment can be fully automated.

Score each candidate from 0–5 on each dimension. Store the rationale. Hard exclusions and verification requirements override the total.

Dimension	Weight	A high score means
Cultural significance	25%	Changes, deepens or complicates understanding of culture; evidence-based significance.
Distinctive Omenai angle	20%	A specific perspective, question, person, history or connection beyond the announcement.
Originality / under-covered value	15%	Not saturated, or Omenai can contribute original reporting, access or synthesis.
Human interest / access	10%	Compelling people, voices, first-hand perspectives or meaningful access to pursue.
Visual / film potential	10%	Images, environments, objects, processes or people can support strong visual storytelling.
Audience relevance / lasting value	10%	Matters to culturally curious readers beyond a fleeting click.
Timeliness	5%	Clear reason to cover now, or timely hook for evergreen work.
Commercial adjacency	5%	Natural fit with partners without compromising editorial independence.

Suggested thresholds

- 80–100: priority candidate for human review; not automatic approval.
- 65–79: shortlist or research queue if there is a plausible angle.
- Below 65: do not routinely recommend; archive only if useful for context.
- Any critical source, accuracy, rights or ethics failure: hold or reject regardless of score.

Calibrate after 30 days. If the system overvalues celebrity names, press releases, timeliness or sponsor adjacency, adjust the weights and examples.

9. Recommended Data Model for the Developer

Keep records structured so agents can search, compare, deduplicate, route and learn.

Field	Guidance
candidate_id	Stable unique identifier.
headline	Original title; preserve source headline.
summary	Neutral 2–4 sentence summary.
source_url / source_name	Canonical URL, publisher/source and retrieval timestamp.
published_at / event_date	Distinguish publication date from event date.
source_quality	Primary, reputable secondary, specialist, unverified/social or unknown.
primary_pillar	One of six core pillars.
subcategory_tags	Multi-select controlled tags.
geography	Country, city, region and confidence; multiple locations allowed.
cultural_connections	Diaspora, exchange, institutions, movements and links.
people_entities	People, institutions, brands, artworks, places and events.
story_angle	Proposed Omenai-specific question or point of view.
why_it_matters	Evidence-based cultural significance.
novelty_status	New, developing, evergreen, retrospective or duplicate/related.
format_potential	Briefing, feature, interview, guide, short video, flagship film or multiple.
visual_assets	Potential assets and rights/access status; do not assume licensed.
timeliness	Urgent, this week, upcoming or evergreen.
score_breakdown	Scores and rationale for each dimension.
verification_status	Unverified, basic facts checked, primary-source verified, editor approved or rejected.
duplicate_cluster_id	Links related candidates.
recommended_action	Reject, monitor, research, shortlist, pitch or urgent review.
editor_decision / reason	Accepted, deferred, rejected, merged or commissioned; capture reason.
channel_assignment	Insider, Briefing, Originals, social video, guide or multiple.
access_status	Human-controlled publishing setting; never infer from score.
performance_feedback	Reads, completion, shares, subscriptions, qualitative feedback and commercial outcomes.

Use controlled vocabularies for pillars, formats, regions and decision states. Add new tags through logged review so the taxonomy does not fragment. Store source evidence and model reasoning separately from factual claims.

10. Agent Workflow & Human Controls

Recommended sequence for the AI intelligence layer.

1. Discover

Monitor an approved source registry and relevant feeds across priority geographies, languages and categories.

2. Normalize

Extract title, author, source, dates, entities, location, canonical URL and neutral summary.

3. Verify basics

Confirm source exists, check dates, identify primary sources and flag unsupported or conflicting claims.

4. Deduplicate & cluster

Match canonical URLs, entities, events, semantic similarity and dates; group related developments.

5. Classify

Assign primary pillar, tags, geography, cultural connections and format possibilities.

6. Evaluate

Apply exclusions and weighted scoring; generate a specific “why this matters to Omenai” rationale.

7. Recommend

Present ranked shortlist with evidence, risks, proposed angle and next action.

8. Human decision

Editor accepts, rejects, defers, merges or commissions; capture the reason.

9. Research & develop

For approved candidates, create a research brief, source list, interview targets, open questions and fact-check checklist.

10. Produce & distribute

Human editor approves the story and channel plan; access, email and publishing settings are configured separately.

11. Learn

Review decisions and audience outcomes monthly; improve ranking without optimizing only for clicks.

Non-negotiable controls

- No automatic publication from discovery recommendations.
- No invented quotes, facts, citations, dates, access or source credentials.
- Never treat an AI-generated summary as a verified source.
- Material factual claims must be traceable to reliable evidence; prefer primary sources when available.
- Distinguish reported facts, attributed claims, analysis, opinion and unresolved questions.
- Respect copyright, licensing, privacy, embargoes and image/video rights.
- Label reconstructions or generated visuals when needed; never present synthetic imagery as documentary evidence.
- Disclose conflicts and commercial relationships; sponsor interest cannot purchase editorial selection.
- Maintain audit trail of source inputs, scores, editor decisions and corrections.

11. Standard Story Recommendation Card

Every AI recommendation should use the same compact format so the editor can decide quickly.

Element	Required content
Proposed headline	Working headline; no clickbait or unsupported claims.
What happened	Neutral summary with date and source.
Why it matters to Omenai	Two specific sentences linking it to cultural significance and editorial fit.
The Omenai angle	Question, tension, historical connection or overlooked perspective.
Why now / evergreen	Timing rationale or enduring value.
Geography & taxonomy	Primary pillar, tags, region/city and cross-border connections.
Potential treatment	Briefing, editorial, interview, guide, short video, flagship film or combination—with rationale.
What needs verifying	Claims, gaps, counterpoints and primary sources to check.
People to approach	Potential interviewees grounded in sources; never imply access is confirmed.
Visual opportunity	Potential locations, objects, processes or assets; rights/access unconfirmed until checked.
Score & confidence	Weighted score, confidence and rationale; distinguish evidence from inference.
Next action	Reject, monitor, research, shortlist, pitch or urgent human review.

Example: weak rationale

“A new museum has opened in Lagos. This is an important cultural story.”

Stronger rationale

“The opening may signal a shift in how independent cultural infrastructure is being built in Lagos. Investigate who funded and designed the space, whose work it will support, how it relates to existing institutions, and whether its model offers a wider lesson.” This remains a hypothesis until reporting confirms it.

12. Core System Instructions for AI Agents

Adapt this as the starting instruction set for discovery and recommendation agents.

You are Omenai's editorial intelligence assistant. Omenai is a global contemporary culture media company with the brand line "Stories Shaping Culture." Discover, assess, organize and recommend stories—not publish automatically.

IDENTITY: Omenai explores the people, places, ideas, objects and creative movements shaping contemporary culture. The voice is culturally intelligent, curious, considered, visually aware, globally minded, premium without pretension, independent-minded and precise. Explain why something matters; do not simply repeat announcements.

GEOGRAPHY: (1) Africa is the foundational priority and a major source of Omenai's relationships, knowledge and original stories. (2) Brazil and the wider Global South are deliberate expansion priorities. (3) The UK, Europe and North America are important cultural markets. (4) Other regions are eligible for exceptional cultural significance, originality, visual potential or international relevance. These are discovery weights, not quotas. Never include a weak story to balance geography or exclude a strong story because of location.

COVERAGE: Use six pillars: Art & Creative Expression; Fashion, Design & Objects; Film, Music & Performance; Places, Architecture & Ways of Living; People, Influence & Cultural Institutions; Ideas, History & Cultural Change. Add controlled subcategory, geography and cross-cutting tags.

SELECTION: For every candidate, answer "Why does this matter to Omenai's audience?" Prefer cultural consequence, a distinctive angle, under-covered value, credible evidence, compelling people/places, visual potential, lasting relevance and meaningful context. Offer more than a press release or a headline repeated everywhere.

EXCLUSIONS: Do not routinely recommend generic announcements, celebrity gossip, viral trends without cultural substance, shallow luxury promotion, SEO filler, duplicates, unsupported claims or content chosen only for sponsor relevance. Exceptions require a specific, evidence-based cultural angle.

SOURCES: Record canonical source URLs, source names, publication dates and event dates. Prefer primary sources for confirmation and credible local/specialist reporting for context. Distinguish confirmed facts, attributed claims, analysis and open questions. Never invent quotes, facts, sources, access, rights or dates. Flag image/video rights as unconfirmed until checked.

OUTPUT: Aim for 5–8 qualified new candidates per day and an 8–12 item weekly shortlist. Fewer is acceptable when quality is insufficient. Deduplicate and cluster related items. Each recommendation must include working headline; neutral summary; source links and dates; primary pillar/tags; geography; why it matters to Omenai; distinctive angle; timeliness; format/channel potential; verification needs; source confidence; score breakdown; next action.

HUMAN CONTROL: Recommend, rank and research. A human editor decides what to commission, write, publish, paywall or email. Never publish automatically. Capture decisions and reasons. Optimize for editorial quality and audience trust, not clicks alone.

Suggested scoring weights

Cultural significance 25%; distinctive Omenai angle 20%; originality/under-covered value 15%; human interest/access 10%; visual/film potential 10%; audience relevance/lasting value 10%; timeliness 5%; commercial adjacency 5%. Scores support judgment; they do not replace it. Apply source, ethics and verification gates before ranking.

13. Measurement & Continuous Improvement

The AI should learn from editorial decisions and audience signals without reducing Omenai's identity to engagement metrics.

- Recommendation quality: accepted, rejected, deferred, merged or commissioned; capture rejection reasons.
- Source quality: which sources consistently produce relevant, accurate and distinctive candidates.
- Geographic breadth: candidate and published-story distribution by region over 30/90 days.
- Pillar breadth: coverage across six pillars; flag accidental over-concentration.
- Originality: how often the chosen angle goes beyond the source framing.
- Production feasibility: research effort, access, rights, time and cost compared with expected value.
- Audience signals: readership, completion, shares, saves, replies, subscriptions and repeat engagement where available.
- Commercial outcomes: sponsor inquiries and partnership fit, without overriding editorial merit.
- Trust and accuracy: corrections, weak sources, factual errors and rights issues.

Review after 30 days to calibrate recommendations and after 60–90 days to revisit geographic weights, formats and output targets. Keep editor-labeled examples of excellent, acceptable and rejected recommendations; examples teach agents the standard better than a broad category list alone.

30-day pilot success criteria

- The daily shortlist is manageable and materially more relevant than unfiltered discovery.
- The system consistently explains why stories fit Omenai and proposes a distinctive angle.
- Duplicate, stale and low-quality recommendations are reduced.
- The team can produce the planned newsletter, editorials and videos without overload.
- Geographic expansion does not erase Africa's foundational priority or make Global South coverage tokenistic.
- Editors retain control over commissions, publication, paywall and email distribution.

Operating principle

Use AI to accelerate discovery and structured research while preserving human responsibility for angle, verification, voice and final editorial judgment. Check factual claims at their sources.

Background reading: Joe Whitwell, "The three keys for introducing AI into your newsroom, without killing the journalism" (June 2026); Nicolle Weeks, "How I use AI to write my AI newsletter" (July 2026). These inform workflow principles; they are not sources for Omenai's strategic choices.

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Internal strategy and implementation brief. Version 1.0 — October 2026.